



TTFI NEEDS TO APPOINT FULL-TIME HEAD COACHES FOR MEN AND WOMEN TO PROVIDE THE BEST POSSIBLE SUPPORT

Making it count: Harmeet Desai, ranked in the 60s, is India's highest-ranked paddler for now, having overtaken Sharath Kamal and G. Sathyan. A. M. FARUQUI

TTFI has successfully staged a full season of domestic tournaments.

But with the Annual General Meeting delayed, primarily due to the cold war between the warring factions and the international stars requesting the calendar be wound up before the New Year, the season ended up being hastily organised.

The TTFI should look at announcing the domestic events calendar well in advance this time, ensuring maximum participation of international stars in national ranking events.

It is also high time the TTFI expanded the domestic ranking system into a much more comprehensive one to motivate paddlers. For starters, a points system can be devised for every round — even qualifiers — at the national ranking tournaments so that every participant will find a mention in the national rankings list.

The age-fudging menace in the

domestic age-group circuit — a bane for Indian sport — has to be handled more strictly to ensure those following the rules are not disheartened.

Despite the domestic issues, the success of Indian table tennis in 2024 will depend on the number of qualifiers for Paris. If any of them get even remotely close to being in medal contention, it will be nothing but icing on the cake!



Sustaining momentum: Manika Batra had achieved her career high ranking of No. 31 in November 2023, but now she needs to maintain consistency throughout 2024 if she wishes to break into the top 25. GETTYIMAGES